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(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title: The Triumphant Stories Among Tumandoks: A Primer Study on the Lived Experiences and Coping Mechanisms Among Panay Bukidnons	
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Program or Project has component (if no proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Component Title:	
Component Leader/s:	
Academic Rank:	

(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/Biological Sciences ☐ Food Research ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension		(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☒ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center							
(4) Site of implementation									
		Municipality/City:							
		Province:							
		Region:							
(5) Classification <table> <tr> <td>Research:</td> <td>Development:</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☒ Basic</td> <td>☐ Pilot Testing</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☐ Applied</td> <td>☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization</td> </tr> </table>		Research:	Development:	☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing	☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization	(6) Mode of Implementation ☐ Single Authorship/Proponent ☒ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☐ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)	
Research:	Development:								
☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing								
☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization								
(7) Sector/Commodity		(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization							

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(9) Rationale (State the research problem and significance of the project to the current needs of the country. The proposal should justify resource expenditure. A typical justification would include a brief introduction, a general statement concerning the historical basis for R & D and, thrusts being addressed, utilization of the expected output and the impact information generated will have on science, the target users and the country.) The Philippines is a country rich in culture and people coming from diverse backgrounds. From Luzon, Visayas, to Mindanao, you are guaranteed to see a glimpse of historical treasures. Every province and/ or city celebrates its own unique quirks that made their community come to be. For instance, we have the Ati-Atihan festival of Aklan, where the people celebrate and honor the Child Jesus, in conjunction to the aboriginal natives that were once that took up residence in the majority of the province. Despite the celebration of the Ati, the general public seems to contradict itself due to the common beliefs that have been instilled upon as for centuries. There are people who travel for hours to enjoy festivals involving dark-skinned people dancing around, and at the end of the day, they go back to their homes and wash themselves with their skin-whitening soaps and lotions. In television dramas, the poorer people are portrayed as dark skinned and dirty. Even the Spanish Colonizers' ideas of indigenous people being ungodly and believing in dark magic still lingers in our society today - this mindset is also known as colonial mentality. The Philippine Statistics Authority (2017) describes Indigenous peoples (IPs) as a group of people who identified themselves by self-ascription and ascription by their predecessors that have continuously lived in an organized community on territory where which they have established their rights to, and have claims of ownership in possessed customs, tradition and other distinctive cultural traits, as well as having political, social and cultural inroads of colonization, non-indigenous religions and culture, and have become historically differentiated from the majority of Filipinos. While the empowerment and recognition of indigenous peoples are encouraged by the government, they are still less privileged in fields such as education (Berondo, 2019). In these times, an individual can face prejudices from other people because of the stigmas that come with the group they belong to; Especially when it is one that is considered to be undervalued in a given society. This commonly occurs when a person is a woman, impoverished, a non-heterosexual, someone who has a distinct physical feature that is not considered as the norm (e.g., being too big, tall or short), or in this case, a member of a different culture, such as the Indigenous Peoples Group. The aforementioned minority groups have met the stigmatizing categories in a social context. As defined by the Mayo Clinic (2017), a stigma manifests when a person views someone else negatively because he or she has a characteristic that is either unconventional, a disadvantage, or simply unknown to the masses. In a narrowed-down scenario, there have been cases of students who are hesitant to admit that they are indigenous because of their fear of being discriminated for it. Even among their classmates and their peers, they have fallen short in the field of socializing with others. Although they have been given protection by law, such as the Republic Act No. 8371, which states to "Recognize, protect, and promote the rights of indigenous cultural communities/Indigenous peoples, creating a national commission on indigenous peoples, establishing implementing mechanisms, appropriating funds therefor and other purposes" (Republic of the Philippines, 1997). The nature of the IPs' past experiences where laws like this weren't approved still hinders their performances, and their efforts to self-acceptance. The notion of alienation has already been imprinted into their minds. The consequences of stigma are numerous, especially for those who have experienced it. Discrimination goes hand in hand with this action, and they can come in forms of blatant aggression or subtle mistreatment. This study shall center on how the IPs are able to cope with their experiences of discrimination, and how they are able to arrive to their present social statuses. The researcher aims to have their experiences serve as an inspiration for the IPs to come out of their comfort zone, and face the struggles that come with their identity.	
(9-A) Project Description (Discuss the project strategy and plan of action of the project. It should also describe the technical procedures and other works needed to carry out the project objectives. The relationship	

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of the project inputs and activities should be explained clearly in this section. Projects similar/related to the proposed project should be mentioned. .)

(10) Objectives/Statement of the Problem (for Social Sciences) (Statement of the specific purpose to address the problem areas of the project.)

The aim of this study is to identify the coping mechanisms of Indigenous People (Categorically the Panay Bukidnon Community) against the stigmas and the threats against their identity, along with concerns regarding societal acceptance. It is on these premises that this research study will be conducted. Specifically basing upon these following questions:

1. What are the lived experiences of Indigenous People in terms of:
 - A. Growing -up Years
 - B. Educational Pursuits
 - C. Professional Life
 - D. Social Acceptance
 - E. Spiritual Endeavors
2. How were they able to cope with their negative experiences?
3. How were they able to maintain their identity as a member of the Panay Bukidnon Community?
4. What pushes them to go further and be successful in life?

(11) Scientific Basis/Theoretical Framework (Include concepts, theories and variables that indicate relevant relationships to be tested.)

Colonial Mentality may be one of the reasons as to why further discrimination against indigenous peoples still occur among fellow countrymen. In a study conducted by Decena (2014), Colonial mentality is the mindset of viewing an ethnicity or culture as inferior, and is also a form of internalized racial oppression. It is one of the many consequences of the Philippines extended history under its colonizers. To further expound on this topic, this study shall use the Postcolonial Theory as its framework. According to Elam (2019), Postcolonial theory is “a body of thought primarily concerned with accounting for the political, aesthetic, economic, historical, and social impact of European colonial rule around the world in the 18th through the 20th century”.

Spain is a country from the European continent. During the Spanish colonization era, the Spaniards were primarily responsible for the cultural erasure during the colonization era. They have enforced the notion of native practices being bad upon the country for approximately three centuries. Despite the country’s liberation from its rule during the late 19th century, the norms that were taught during that time period are still prevalent today, and it is seen through how modern Filipinos treat their indigenous communities.

(12) Review of Literature/Prior Art Search (Related researchers/activities that have been conducted. State-of –the-art of current technology / information from which the project proposal will take-off).

A. Indigenous People

As reported by the International Work Group for Indigenous Affairs (2020), the Philippine population consists of approximately 102 million people, and it is estimated that around 10 to 20 percent of the population consists of indigenous people. Such numbers conclude that Indigenous peoples are indeed a minority. They generally live in landmasses abundant of natural resources, yet they remain to be one of the underprivileged and disadvantageous communities of the country. Problems such as discrimination, disputes over land ownership and cultural erasure, degradation of resource bases, armed conflict, high unemployment, underemployment and illiteracy rate are no stranger to Indigenous groups (International Labor Organization, n.d.).

B. Stigma

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A stigma manifests when a person views someone else negatively because he or she has a characteristic that is either unconventional, a disadvantage, or simply unknown to the masses (Mayo Clinic, 2017). The stigma discussed in this study can be divided into two categories. One being Social Stigma, and the other being self-perceived stigma. Pallipedia (2020) stated that social stigma is a prejudice against a person with distinguished social characteristics that differentiate them from the norm. With indigenous groups such as the Tumandok or the Panay Bukidnon, they generally have darker skin, and have a shorter stature than the common folk - such characteristics makes it easy for others to categorize them into negative generalizations (Valdeavilla, 2018).

C. Discrimination

According to Amnesty International (2022), discrimination happens when someone cannot fully enjoy his or her rights as a human because of an unfair distinction made in policy, law or treatment. Discrimination can be in different categories such as Direct Discrimination (explicit distinction between groups where the one group is less privileged than the other, such as an indigenous person being less prioritized in healthcare due to his or her financial status), Indirect Discrimination (where a regulation is presented in a neutral format, such as a now defunct law dictating how one must reach a certain educational level in order to vote), and Intersectional Discrimination (where several forms of discrimination overlap to worsen the disadvantages, such as a woman from an indigenous group suffering from the effects of misogyny, colorism, and colonial mentality).

D. Harmful Effects of Stigma and Discrimination.

With stigma, one can experience a reluctance to seek help, bullying, physical violence, harassment, self-doubt, fewer opportunities for work, school, socialization, or finding proper housing (Mayo Clinic, 2017). The American Psychological Association (2015) reports that people who experience discrimination are more likely to experience higher stress levels and lower health. Indigenous people already make up a smaller percentage of the Philippine population, as they continue to undergo these stressors, the numbers may continue to decrease and might result into ethnic cleansing.

E. RA 8317

Laws were enacted to protect the rights of Indigenous peoples. The most notable one is the Republic Act No. 8371 of 1997, otherwise known as the "Indigenous Peoples Rights Act 1997", is an Act to recognize, protect and promote the rights of Indigenous Cultural Communities/Indigenous Peoples, creating a National Commission on Indigenous Peoples, establishing implementing mechanisms, appropriating funds therefor, and for other purposes. The Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (n.d.) has summarized this act as a provision for the promotion and recognition of the rights of Indigenous Cultural Communities/Indigenous Peoples (ICCs/IPs), with a view to preserve their culture, traditions and institutions and to ensure the equal protection and non-discrimination of members. The Act is divided into the following Chapters: General Provisions (I); Definition of Terms (II); Rights to Ancestral Domains (III); Right to Self-governance and Empowerment (IV); Social Justice and Human Rights (V); Cultural Integrity (VI); National Commission on Indigenous Peoples (NCIP) (VII); Delineation and Recognition of Ancestral Domains (VIII); Jurisdiction and Procedures for Enforcement of Rights (IX); Ancestral Domains Fund (X); Penalties (XI); Merger of the Office for Northern Cultural Communities (ONCC) and the Office for Southern Cultural Communities (OSCC) (XII); Final Provisions (XIII).

According to the definition provided in Chapter II the term "ancestral domain" comprises "lands, inland waters, coastal areas and natural resources therein, held under a claim of ownership, occupied or possessed by ICCs/IPs, by themselves or through their ancestors, communally or individually since time immemorial..."; the term "ancestral land" means any "land occupied, possessed and utilized by individuals, families and clans who are members of the ICCs/IPs....".

ICCs/IPs whose ancestral domains have been officially delineated and determined according to the procedure set out in this Act shall be issued a certificate of ancestral domain title (CADT) in the name of the community concerned, which shall be registered before the Register of Deeds. The rights of ownership and possession of ICCs/IPs to their ancestral domains shall include: (a) the right of ownership; (b) the right to develop, control and use lands and natural resources; (c) the right to stay in the territories and not to be removed therefrom; (d) the right of resettlement in suitable sites in case of displacement; (e) the right to regulate the entry of immigrants; (f) the right to safe and clean air and water; (g) the right to claim parts of reservations; (h) the right to resolve land conflicts in accordance with customary laws of the area concerned (only in default thereof the complaints shall be submitted to amicable settlement and to the Courts of Justice).

The Act makes provision for the establishment of the National Commission on Indigenous Cultural Communities/Indigenous Peoples (NCIP), which shall serve as the primary government agency for the assistance of ICCs/IPs. The Commission shall inter alia: (a) review and assess the conditions of ICCs/IPs; (b)

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formulate, coordinate and implement policies, plans and programs to promote and protect the rights and well-being of the ICCs/IPs; (c) request and engage services of technical assistance; (d) issue certificate of ancestral land/domain title; (e) negotiate for funds and in general be responsible for the financial management and coordination of the communities; (f) issue appropriate certification as a pre-condition to the grant of permit, lease, grant, or any other similar authority for the disposition, utilization, management and appropriation by any private individual, etc. on any part or portion of the ancestral domain; (g) decide all appeals from the decisions and acts of all the various Offices within the Commission; (h) to promulgate the necessary regulations and rules for the implementation of the Act.

Chapter X provides for the creation of the Ancestral Domains Fund to cover compensation for expropriated lands, delineation and development of ancestral domains.

F. Colonial Mentality

Colonial mentality is the mindset of viewing an ethnicity or culture as inferior, and is also a form of internalized racial oppression. It is one of the many consequences of the Philippines extended history under its colonizers (Decena, 2014). In an article written by David (2017), a Colonial Mentality Scale was used to determine if people exhibited signs of colonial mentality. Findings reported that 56 percent of Filipinos showed a strong tendency to think that American culture is more superior to Filipino cultures. In the article, it has been explained that there are at least five signs of colonial mentality among Filipinos. These are as such: a.) Feeling a sense of inferiority because of one's nationality and ethnicity, b.) Harboring shame, and other negative feelings towards a person with Filipino roots, c.) rejecting typical Filipino physical traits, d.) Discriminating those who are less-westernized, such as people from the provinces and indigenous people, and e.) Tolerating or minimizing historical and contemporary oppression of fellow Filipinos.

(13) Methodology (Details such as; a) variables to be measured and evaluated; b) treatments to be used and their layout; c) experimental procedures and design; d) statistical analysis; e) evaluation method and observations to be made, strategies for implementation.)

This study will utilize a qualitative research design using the phenomenological approach. Respondents of the study shall be the randomly selected Panay Bukidnon members (professionals??) of Tapaz, Capiz. The researcher will use an interview method with a formulated set of questions to gather the necessary data. After the collection of answers, Thematic analysis will be applied for data interpretation.

(14) Major Activities/Work plan (Enumerate in chronological order the task to be undertaken. Use gantt chart. Below is an example. This can be modified base on your desired Work plan.)

Research Objectives	Year 1					Year 2				
	July	Aug	Sept	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr
1. Field work/observation										
2. Analysis of data gathered from observation										
3. Lay-outing, Editing and Printing of 100 copies of										

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	- Professional fees (laboratory analysis and other related fees)		
	- Miscellaneous (for incidental expenses)		
	- Printing		
	C. CAPITAL OUTLAY		
	Total		

(19) Literature Cited (include only those references published in reputable journals, and at least that from CAPSU Research Journal, <http://researchjournal.capsu.edu.ph/>)

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(20) Capsule Curriculum Vitae (One-page brief C.V. only)

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Bachelor of Secondary Education major in Physical Education
Master of Arts in Teaching Performing Arts
Certificate Program major in Cultural Education
Doctor of Physical Education (CAR)

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RESEARCH INSTRUMENTS

"Interview Questionnaire"

1. What age did you start to experience discrimination?
2. What kind of discrimination?
3. How did you feel during these experiences?
4. What did you do about it?
5. How do these experiences affect your spiritual beliefs?
6. How do these experiences affect your general outlook in life?
7. What are your main motivators in life?
8. As an IP how was your experience in school environment?
9. What is your current profession and social status/class?
10. How did you pursue your job?
11. As an IP, how was your experience in your working environment?
12. How common is it for you and your community to experience discrimination, and how bad is it?
13. What is normal to your community that others find odd?
14. What makes you decide to embrace your identity as an IP?
15. Can you recall the moment where you thought that you should hide your identity as an IP? If yes, please explain.